ARC COMPUTE

Go-to-Market Strategy & PM Tool Analysis

Sponsor Review Presentation

Project Team 5 · Northeastern University

PRESENTED BY

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For Arc Compute Leadership

Project Purpose

Refine GTM Strategy

Strengthen Arc Compute's go-to-market approach through improved vertical targeting and market positioning.

Improve ICPs

Enhance Ideal Customer Profiles across 5 key verticals for sharper, more actionable targeting.

Evaluate PM Practices

Assess current project management workflows and identify opportunities to improve execution.

Recommend PM Tools

Identify scalable tools to replace fragmented Excel and Trello workflows as the team grows.

Strategic Recommendations

Deliver actionable guidance for Arc Compute leadership to drive growth and operational efficiency.

Project Phases Overview

01	02	03	04	05	06
INITIATION & PLANNING	**GTM & ICP ANALYSIS**	**PM TOOL EVALUATION**	**SYNTHESIS & DELIVERABLES**	**REVIEW & CLOSEOUT**	**POST-IMPL. (ARC COMPUTE)**
Jan 5–12	Jan 13–Feb 20	Feb 23–Mar 16	Mar 16–23	Mar 24–29	Apr 1–Jun 24
Kickoff & charter Stakeholder alignment Schedule baseline RACI matrix Risk register Budget & contingency plan WBS & resource plan	5 ICP deep-dives TAM/SAM/SOM SWOT & prioritisation Competitive landscape Vertical market sizing GTM strategy report Market expansion plan	Current state assessment 4-tool comparison matrix Implementation roadmap Dual-tool recommendation Change management plan Cost-benefit analysis Training framework	Data analysis & synthesis Exec sponsor presentation Supporting documentation Integrated project plan QA & risk final report Milestone M9 sign-off Stakeholder review cycle	Final internal review Final sponsor presentation Lessons learned log Reserve release to sponsor M10 milestone sign-off Project archives completed Grade submission	GTM pilot execution PM tool full cutover (May 4) M11 success confirmed 30-day usage review First ICP outreach wave Pipeline tracking begins KPI dashboard live

Total lifecycle: 122.97 days · Student team engagement: Jan 5 – Mar 29, 2026 · Post-implementation: Apr 1 – Jun 24, 2026 (Arc Compute)

Project Cost Overview

$22,500

ESTIMATED PROJECT COST

Labor accounts for 89% of total project investment, reflecting the analytical and strategic nature of deliverables.

Cost Breakdown

Labor
$20,000

Research Resources
$1,500

PM Tool Subscription
$500

Collaboration Tools
$500

Contingency Reserve & Risk Exposure

$2,250

CONTINGENCY RESERVE (10%)

$2,320

TOTAL WEIGHTED EMV

Risk Event	Prob.	Impact	Wt. EMV
Tight deadlines; research tasks delayed	45%	$5,000	$2,250
Team workload; competing academic tasks cause delays	40%	$3,000	$1,200
Limited market data; insufficient GTM datasets	40%	$6,000	$2,400
Stakeholder unavailability; interviews not occurring	35%	$4,000	$1,400
Interview/survey response delays extending schedule	30%	$4,000	$1,200
Total weighted exposure: $2,320 → Reserve requested: $2,250 (10% of $22,500 project baseline)			

Reserve Policy: Draws up to $500 approved by weekly Project Manager; $501–$2,250 requires instructor approval within 72 hours. Funds are exclusively for documented risk events, not general overruns. Unused reserve returned to sponsor at project closeout.

Implementation Time Requirements

Phase 6 Total Duration: April 1 to June 24, 2026 (84 calendar days) · Arc Compute executes independently

GTM Strategy Execution

Apr 1 to Jun 1, 2026 (61 days)

Week 1-2: Align ICP messaging with sales and marketing teams
Week 3-10: Launch pilot outreach campaign for top-ranked vertical
Milestone M10: GTM Pilot results reviewed Jun 1

PM Tool Rollout

Apr 1 to May 4, 2026 (33 days)

Week 1-2: Finalize procurement and assign PM tool champion
Week 2-4: 10-day parallel operation period alongside Excel and Trello
Milestone M9: Full cutover confirmed May 4

Change Management and Adoption

Apr 1 to May 31, 2026 (concurrent)

Week 1-2: User training sessions for Microsoft Project and Asana
Ongoing: Champion monitors adoption and escalates resistance

Monitoring and Continuous Improvement

May to Jun 24, 2026

Define KPIs for GTM campaign and PM tool adoption
Conduct 30-day post-implementation review and apply refinements
Milestone M11: Success confirmed Jun 24, 2026

Key Project Milestones

PROJECT PHASES (Jan – Mar 29)

- **Ph 1–2 Initiation, Planning & GTM Analysis** · Jan 5 – Feb 20, 2026
- **Ph 3–4 PM Tool Evaluation & Synthesis** · Feb 23 – Mar 23, 2026
- **Ph 5 Review, Final Presentation & Handover** · Mar 24 – Mar 29, 2026
- **Ph 6a GTM Strategy Execution (Arc Compute)** · Apr – Jun 1, 2026
- **Ph 6b PM Tool Rollout (Arc Compute)** · Full cutover May 4, 2026
- **Ph 6c Change Management & Adoption** · Apr – May, 2026
- **Ph 6d Monitoring, Evaluation & Continuous Improvement** · 30-day review
- **M11 Post-Implementation Success Confirmed** · Jun 24, 2026

POST-IMPLEMENTATION MILESTONES

M9 Full Cutover to New PM Tool
May 4, 2026 · Arc Compute executes independently

M10 GTM Pilot Complete & Results Reviewed
Jun 1, 2026 · Arc Compute executes independently

M11 Post-Implementation Success Confirmed
Jun 24, 2026 · Arc Compute executes independently

Implementation Resource Requirements

Resource	Requirement	Source
PM Tool Champion Human Resource	1 named internal lead per team; dedicated 50% capacity during rollout period	Assign from existing Arc Compute staff; no external hire required
PM Tool Licenses Technology Resource	Microsoft Project (strategic) and Asana (operational); team-wide license	Procure directly via Microsoft 365 and Asana Business tier; est. $500/yr combined
GTM Campaign Budget Financial Resource	Pilot outreach campaign for top-ranked vertical (content, channels, outreach tools)	Allocated from Arc Compute's existing marketing budget; no new headcount required
Market Intelligence Data Research Resource	ICP validation data, pipeline analytics, and competitive signals for quarterly reviews	Internal CRM pipeline data supplemented by Grand View Research and Market reports
Governance Owner Human Resource	Responsible for milestone reporting, risk register, and review cadence	Assign from existing leadership team; must be confirmed prior to March 29 handover

Assessment of Arc Compute's 5 Existing ICPs

Strong

Finance & FinTech

Strong ICP alignment with AI-driven risk modeling and fraud detection use cases. Recommend expanding focus to mid-market financial institutions.

Moderate

HealthTech

Demand for GPU compute in medical imaging and genomics is growing. ICP needs sharper definition of on-premise vs. cloud-hybrid preferences.

Strong

Media & Entertainment

High HPC demand for rendering and ML pipelines. ICP accurately captures studio and post-production targets. Minor refresh needed on streaming segment.

Needs Refinement

RetailTech

ICP overly broad. Recommend narrowing to large-scale retailers using real-time demand forecasting and computer vision at the edge.

Moderate

Private Equity

Growing interest in GPU-as-a-Service portfolio investments. ICP should be updated to reflect infrastructure-focused PE funds specifically.

Arc Compute SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS

On-premise GPU ownership, no cloud lock-in
Strong data sovereignty & compliance positioning
Predictable cost model vs. volatile cloud GPU pricing
Serves mature, production-stage AI workloads

WEAKNESSES

Limited brand recognition vs. AWS, Azure, GCP
Fragmented ICP targeting & early-stage PM processes
Higher capex barrier vs. pay-as-you-go cloud

OPPORTUNITIES

Surging cloud GPU costs driving on-prem migration
Regulatory pressure (GDPR, HIPAA) favouring private infra
5 new high-fit verticals identified (HE&R, Energy, Gov, Mfg, Telco)

THREATS

Hyperscalers investing in private/hybrid cloud to close the gap
Rapid AI market evolution may outpace ICP assumptions
Competitors (CoreWeave, Lambda Labs) with deeper pockets

Market Expansion Opportunities

PRIORITY

Higher Education & Research
Continuous HPC demand for AI research, climate modeling, and scientific simulations. On-premise preference aligns with Arc Compute's infrastructure model.

HIGH FIT

Energy & Utilities
Large-scale simulations and grid optimization require significant GPU compute capacity on an ongoing basis.

HIGH FIT

Public Sector / Government
Classified data processing and defense computing increasingly demand on-premise HPC solutions with strong security guarantees.

MODERATE

Manufacturing & Industrial AI
Predictive maintenance, computer vision, and process optimization drive GPU infrastructure needs across mid-to-large manufacturers.

MODERATE

Telecommunications
Network traffic analysis and 5G deployment modeling create strong, sustained demand for high-performance computing resources.

TAM / SAM / SOM by Vertical

	Finance & FinTech	HealthTech	Media & Ent.	RetailTech	Private Equity
TAM	**$28.5B** AI/ML in financial services	**$45.2B** AI in healthcare global	**$19.8B** HPC rendering & ML	**$12.3B** AI in retail global	**$9.4B** GPU-as-a-Service inv.
SAM	**$4.2B** On-prem GPU compute	**$5.8B** Private GPU infra	**$3.1B** Studio on-prem GPU	**$1.4B** Edge CV & forecasting	**$1.8B** Infra-focused PE funds
SOM	**$210M** Mid-market firms 3-yr	**$290M** Imaging & genomics labs	**$155M** Tier 1-2 studios 3-yr	**$70M** Large retailers (post-refinement)	**$90M** Infra PE initial focus

Sources: Grand View Research 2024; MarketsandMarkets 2024; Mordor Intelligence 2024; IIF-EY 2024; NVIDIA 2024. SAM/SOM calculated from Arc Compute on-prem positioning and addressable buyer segments.

Recommended Project Management Tools

PRIMARY

Microsoft Project

- Strategic planning & milestone tracking
- Baseline schedule management
- Critical path visualization
- Resource allocation controls
- Executive reporting dashboards

OPERATIONAL

Asana

- Cross-functional execution support
- Campaign coordination workflows
- Team task visibility & tracking
- Flexible project templates
- Integration with existing tools

PM Tool Comparison Matrix

Criteria	MS Project	Asana	Monday.com	Jira
Ease of Adoption	Low–Medium	**High**	**High**	Medium–Low
Marketing Alignment	Medium	**High**	**High**	Medium
Scheduling Control	**Very High**	Medium	Medium	High
Scalability	**High**	**High**	Med–High	**Very High**
GTM Campaign Fit	Low	**High**	**High**	Low
VERDICT	**✓ RECOMMENDED**	**✓ RECOMMENDED**	Not selected	Not selected

Why this dual approach: MS Project delivers critical path control, milestone tracking, and executive reporting. Asana drives GTM campaign execution and cross-functional visibility. Monday.com and Jira were eliminated, Monday scales poorly for governance and Jira is optimised for engineering, not GTM-led organisations.

Risks for Arc Compute

01

ICP Staleness Risk

RISK As Arc Compute expands into new verticals, existing Ideal Customer Profiles may become outdated and misaligned with actual buyer segments.

ACTION Institutionalize quarterly ICP reviews cross-referenced with active sales data and emerging market signals.

02

Rapid AI Market Shifts

RISK The AI infrastructure market is evolving rapidly; assumptions about customer demand or competitive positioning may become invalid within months.

ACTION Establish a quarterly strategy review cadence to reassess vertical prioritization and GTM assumptions against live market signals.

03

Governance Adoption Risk

RISK Lightweight governance practices introduced post-project may not be sustained without dedicated ownership within Arc Compute.

ACTION Assign a named governance owner before handover and build quarterly review checkpoints into existing operational rhythms.

How We Assured Deliverable Quality

100% Peer Review Rate

Every deliverable peer-reviewed before submission

100% Source Currency

All cited data from sources published within 18 months

≥90% On-Time Submission

At most one late submission permitted across all deliverables

≥80% Sponsor Acceptance

ICP/GTM deliverables accepted by sponsor without major revision

Quality Gate Process

Source audit → Structured peer review → QC inspection → Milestone checklist sign-off → Sponsor feedback resolution

Rotating weekly roles ensured no team member reviewed their own work. All 11 deliverables tracked in a living Quality Register (QC: Albert K. Essuman).

Strategic Recommendations for Arc Compute

01 Adopt Microsoft Project for strategic planning and critical path management, and Asana for day-to-day campaign coordination, replacing the current fragmented Excel and Trello workflows

02 Conduct quarterly ICP reviews; refine RetailTech (edge computer vision focus), HealthTech (on-premise vs. cloud-hybrid), and Private Equity (infrastructure-focused funds only)

03 Introduce milestone-based reporting, a centralized risk register, and weekly project review meetings; assign a named governance owner prior to the March 29 project handover

04 Validate all ICP targeting assumptions against live pipeline data before committing GTM budget, replacing the current reliance on qualitative input with a documented data validation step

05 Assign a named PM tool champion per team, conduct a parallel operation period alongside existing tools, and complete user training prior to the full platform cutover milestone on May 4, 2026

06 Prioritize Higher Education and Research, Energy and Utilities, and Public Sector as new verticals; defer Manufacturing and Telecommunications pending traction in primary segments

Implementation Roadmap — Phase 6

SHORT TERM

Apr – Jun 2026 (Phase 6a–6c)

- Finalize PM tool procurement & assign champion, full cutover by May 4
- Launch pilot GTM campaign for top-ranked vertical, KPIs reviewed Jun 1
- Assign named governance owner & establish weekly review cadence

MEDIUM TERM

Jun – Sep 2026 (Phase 6d)

- Conduct 30-day post-implementation review, confirm success Jun 24
- Expand GTM campaigns to second & third priority verticals based on pilot data
- Refine GTM strategy and PM workflows based on 30-day review findings

LONG TERM

Sep 2026 – Ongoing

- Explore moderate-fit verticals: Manufacturing & Telecommunications
- Run quarterly ICP reviews tied to live pipeline & market signals
- Scale governance model & PM platform as team headcount grows

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Thank You

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